Era 9: Sectionalism & Antebellum Crisis

1848–1860 · APUSH Period 5 · Lessons 20–22

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 20 *The slave South · enslaved people's experience ·*

4.12 (LO L): Explain continuities and changes in the experience of African Americans from 1800 to 1848.

4.13 (LO M): Explain how geographic and environmental factors shaped the development of the South from 1800 to 1848.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 4.12 *African Americans in the Early Republic* · Topic 4.13 *The Society of the South in the Early Republic*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **King Cotton**

2. **planter aristocracy**

3. **yeoman farmers**

4. **"peculiar institution"**

5. **internal slave trade**

6. **resistance & rebellion**

7. American Colonization Society

8. Underground Railroad

People

Who they were and why they matter.

9. Nat Turner

Events

What happened and why it matters.

10. Denmark Vesey plot (1822)

11. Nat Turner's Rebellion (1831)

Lesson 20 · Key Question *The slave South · enslaved people's experience ·*

4.12 (LO L): Explain continuities and changes in the experience of African Americans from 1800 to 1848.

4.13 (LO M): Explain how geographic and environmental factors shaped the development of the South from 1800 to 1848.

Explain how the cotton economy shaped Southern society between 1800 and 1860, and describe ONE way enslaved people resisted slavery.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 21 *Sectional crisis · Compromise of 1850 · Kansas-Nebraska ·*

5.4 (LO D): Explain similarities and differences in how regional attitudes affected federal policy after the Mexican– American War.
5.5 (LO E): Explain the effects of immigration on American culture from 1844 to 1877.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 5.4 *The Compromise of 1850* · Topic 5.5 *Sectional Conflict: Regional Differences*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

12. **Fugitive Slave Act**

13. **Uncle Tom's Cabin (1852)**

14. **popular sovereignty**

15. **Free-Soil movement**

16. **Republican Party**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

17. **Stephen Douglas**

18. **Harriet Beecher Stowe**

19. **Charles Sumner**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

20. Compromise of 1850

21. Kansas-Nebraska Act (1854)

22. Bleeding Kansas (1854–59)

23. Ostend Manifesto (1854)

Lesson 21 · Key Question *Sectional crisis · Compromise of 1850 · Kansas-Nebraska ·*

5.4 (LO D): Explain similarities and differences in how regional attitudes affected federal policy after the Mexican– American War.
5.5 (LO E): Explain the effects of immigration on American culture from 1844 to 1877.

Explain how the Compromise of 1850 and the Kansas-Nebraska Act increased, rather than settled, sectional conflict over slavery in the territories.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 22 *Dred Scott · John Brown · Election of 1860*

5.6 (LO G): Explain the political causes of the Civil War.
5.7 (LO H): Describe the effects of Lincoln's election.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 5.6 *Failure of Compromise* · Topic 5.7 *Election of 1860 and Secession*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

24. secession

25. Freeport Doctrine

26. Constitutional Union Party

People

Who they were and why they matter.

27. Roger Taney

28. John Brown

Events

What happened and why it matters.

29. Dred Scott v. Sandford (1857)

30. Lincoln-Douglas Debates (1858)

31. John Brown's raid on Harpers Ferry (1859)

32. Election of 1860

33. South Carolina secedes (Dec. 1860)

Lesson 22 · Key Question *Dred Scott · John Brown · Election of 1860*

5.6 (LO G): Explain the political causes of the Civil War.
5.7 (LO H): Describe the effects of Lincoln's election.

Explain how the Dred Scott decision, John Brown's raid, and the election of 1860 led Southern states to secede from the Union.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Compromises and Crises over Slavery in the Territories

Event	What it did	Northern reaction	Southern reaction
Compromise of 1850			
Fugitive Slave Act (1850)			
Kansas-Nebraska Act (1854)			
Dred Scott v. Sandford (1857)			
John Brown's raid (1859)			

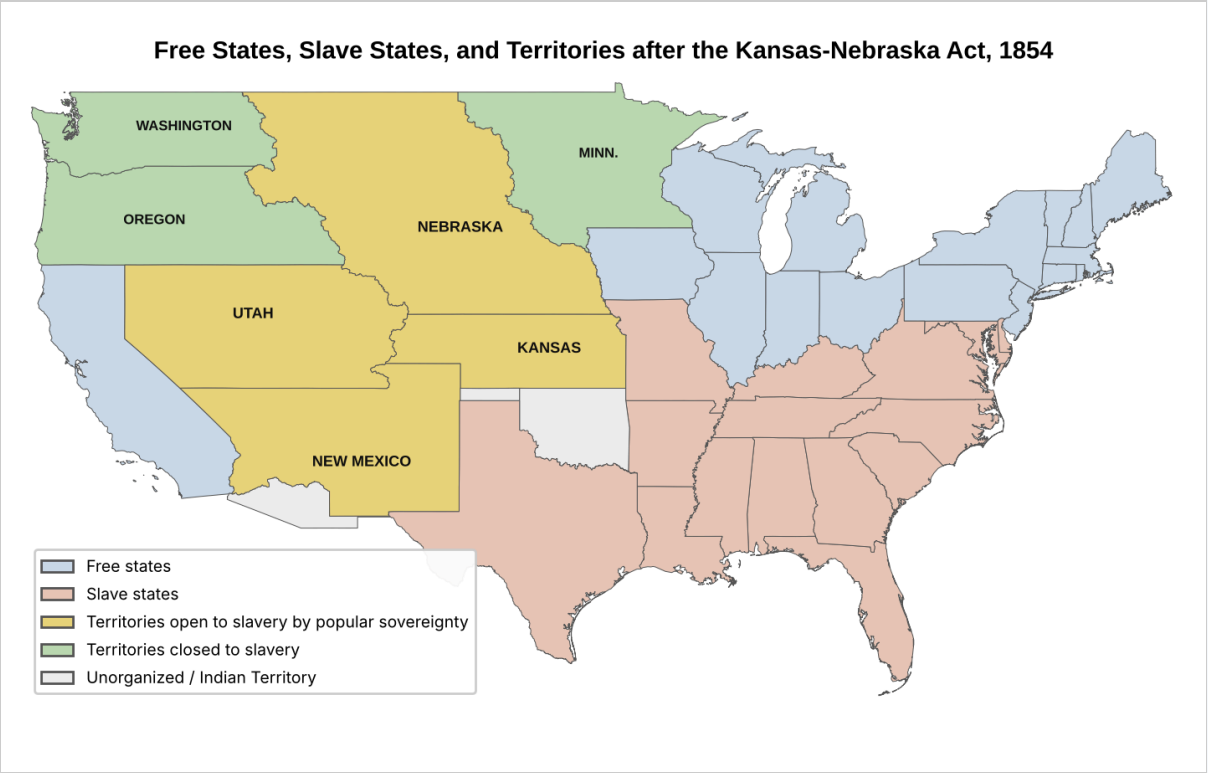
The Election of 1860

Candidate (party)	Position on slavery in the territories	Where his support came from
Abraham Lincoln (Republican)		
Stephen Douglas (Northern Democrat)		
John C. Breckinridge (Southern Democrat)		
John Bell (Constitutional Union)		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

Map: Free states, slave states, and territories after the Kansas-Nebraska Act, June 1854



Map drawn for this guide from state and territory boundaries in the Newberry Library's Atlas of Historical County Boundaries.

a. Briefly describe what the map shows about how the question of slavery in the western territories was to be decided in 1854.

b. Briefly explain ONE reason the Kansas-Nebraska Act (1854) provoked opposition in the North.

c. Briefly explain ONE other development between 1850 and 1860 that increased sectional conflict over slavery.

DBQ Practice · Sourcing: Point of View

PROMPT

Evaluate the relative importance of the causes of growing sectional conflict between the North and the South from 1848 to 1860.

Your task: Write 2–3 sentences explaining how Frederick Douglass's point of view is relevant to an argument that answers the prompt, using the document on this page.

What earns the point: To earn credit, explain how the author's point of view shapes what the document says and why that matters for your argument (for example, how speaking as a formerly enslaved abolitionist affects Douglass's message). Identifying the point of view is not enough. On the real DBQ you would do this for at least two documents.

Frederick Douglass, speech to the Rochester Ladies' Anti-Slavery Society, Rochester, New York, July 5, 1852 ("What to the Slave Is the Fourth of July?")

What, to the American slave, is your 4th of July? I answer: a day that reveals to him, more than all other days in the year, the gross injustice and cruelty to which he is the constant victim. To him, your celebration is a sham; your boasted liberty, an unholy license; your national greatness, swelling vanity; your sounds of rejoicing are empty and heartless; your denunciations of tyrants, brass fronted impudence; your shouts of liberty and equality, hollow mockery; your prayers and hymns, your sermons and thanksgivings, with all your religious parade, and solemnity, are, to him, mere bombast, fraud, deception, impiety, and hypocrisy—a thin veil to cover up crimes which would disgrace a nation of savages. There is not a nation on the earth guilty of practices, more shocking and bloody, than are the people of these United States, at this very hour.

Text: Teaching American History, Ashbrook Center (from P. S. Foner, ed., Frederick Douglass: Selected Speeches and Writings, 1999). Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Era 10 preview: eleven Southern states left the Union after Lincoln's election. Watch how a war fought first to preserve the Union also became a war to end slavery.*